DINNER · POPPY'S KITCHEN



Pepperoni Pizza Pasta Bake

Pasta and marinara baked with mozzarella and crispy pepperoni on top.

45 min
START TO TABLE

4, plus a lunch
SERVES

🧺 The must-haves

Put these on the counter **before you start**. Out of one? Use the swap next to it. That's it, keep going.

☐ **Rao's fusilli (short pasta)**	**Out?** any short pasta
☐ **Rao's marinara**	**Out?** any jar of pasta sauce
☐ **Shredded mozzarella**	**Out?** any melty cheese
☐ **Pepperoni**	**Out?** skip it, or add sausage or veggies

✨ **If we have them:** grated parmesan, oregano, garlic powder, mini sweet peppers, mushrooms. Skip any of these.

🔥 How it goes

1. Pull the must-haves onto the counter. Oven to 400°F. Big pot of salted water on.
2. Cook the pasta 2 minutes less than the box says. Save ½ cup pasta water, then drain. ⏱️ 9 min
3. Stir the pasta with the sauce, the pasta water and half the cheese. Pour into a 9×13 dish.
4. Rest of the cheese on top, then pepperoni. Bake until bubbling and the pepperoni curls. ⏱️ 18–20 min
5. Rest 5 minutes before scooping.

🔑 THE ONE THING THAT MATTERS

Pull the pasta 2 minutes early. It finishes in the oven without going mushy.

✅ IT'S DONE WHEN

Bubbling at the edges and the pepperoni is crisp.

🛟 **Plan B:** No time to bake? Toss it all in the pot, melt the cheese on top, and eat.

Done? Tell Poppy how it went. Scan to vote and send tweaks with 💡.
Poppy's draft, not family-tested yet